

Interview Process, Negotiation & Execution Playbook

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Senior Flutter Developer — Interview Process, Negotiation & Execution Playbook

This playbook covers the **entire end-to-end interview process** for your upcoming role as a **Senior Flutter Developer (Portal/Mobile)** in the UAE / Dubai market. It prepares you for the HR round, technical screening, live pair-programming etiquette, and offer negotiation.

1. The 5-Stage Interview Process Breakdown

THE 5 INTERVIEW STAGES	
Stage 1: Screen	HR / Recruiter (15–30 mins) – Visa, AED, Availability
Stage 2: Tech Deep	Tech Lead (45–60 mins) – Architecture & Internals
Stage 3: Coding	Live Coding / Pair Programming (60 mins)
Stage 4: Manager	Engineering Manager (45 mins) – Culture & Agile
Stage 5: Offer	Director / HR Offer & Contract Negotiation

2. Stage 1: HR & Recruiter Screening (UAE / Dubai Specific)

In the UAE and Gulf market, recruiters have strict filter criteria. You must answer these smoothly:

Q1: "What is your current notice period and availability?"

- **Your Answer:**

*"I am immediately available to join. I can complete onboarding and start within 1 to 2 business days."
(This is a huge competitive advantage over candidates who have 30 to 60-day notice periods).*

Q2: "What is your current visa status in the UAE?"

- **Your Answer:**

"I am a UAE Resident with a valid visa and Emirates ID, and I am fully authorized to work. Transitioning to a company visa or working under an approved contract is straightforward."

Q3: "The role is for Dubai / Abu Dhabi and open to contract. Are you open to that?"

- **Your Answer:**

"Yes, absolutely. I am based in the UAE and open to both Dubai-based contracts (such as 6-month extendable contracts) and full-time permanent roles. Relocating or commuting within Dubai/Abu Dhabi is completely fine for me."

Q4: "What are your salary expectations?"

- **Strategy:** Never give a single rigid number; give a realistic, senior-level range in **AED (Arab Emirates Dirham)**.
- **Your Answer:**

*"Based on my close to 5 years of hands-on experience architecting cross-platform mobile and web portal platforms, and the market standards in Dubai for a Senior Flutter Developer, I am looking in the range of **18,000 to 22,000 AED per month** (or the equivalent daily/monthly contract rate), depending on the total package, medical benefits, and contract duration. However, finding the right technical fit and long-term project impact is my priority, and I am open to a fair offer for the right role."*

3. Stage 2 & 3: Live Coding & Screen-Share Etiquette

During a live screen-share (Zoom, Google Meet, Teams, or CoderPad):

The 5 Golden Rules of Live Screen-Share

1. **The "Think Aloud" Protocol:**
 - Never stay silent for more than 15 seconds.
 - Say what you are doing as you type: *"I am creating an immutable state class first so that our BLoC has clean, predictable emissions..."*
 2. **Clarify Edge Cases Before Writing Code:**
 - *"Before I begin, should this handle empty lists or null inputs?"*
 - *"On web/portal, should this adapt if the window width drops below 768px?"*
 - **Result:** Interviewers immediately mark you as a Senior Engineer because juniors jump straight into typing without thinking.
 3. **What to Do If You Get a Compiler or Syntax Bug:**
 - **Do NOT panic:** Every engineer encounters typos and syntax errors.
 - Read the error message out loud: *"Okay, the analyzer says `The argument type 'String?' cannot be assigned to 'String'`. That's because our entity has a nullable field here—let me add a defensive fallback with `?? ''`."*
 - Showing a calm, methodical debugging mindset is often worth **more points** than writing code with zero typos.
 4. **Write at Least One Quick Test or Assertion:**
 - Once your function is written, don't just say *"I'm done."*
 - Say: *"Let me write a quick test case to verify our edge cases with an unclosed 24-hour shift..."*
 - Interviewers love seeing test-driven discipline.
 5. **Keep Your Workspace Clean:**
 - Close irrelevant browser tabs and notifications before screen-sharing.
 - Increase font size in VS Code / Android Studio (`Cmd + +`) so the interviewer can read your code easily.
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4. Stage 4: Engineering Manager & Agile Leadership

In the managerial round, they want to know how you operate in a team:

Q: "How do you run your daily standups and sprint planning?"

- **Your Answer:**

"In our 2-week sprints, we start with Sprint Planning where user stories have clear Definition of Ready (DoR) and Acceptance Criteria. In daily standups, I keep my updates concise: what I completed yesterday, what I am delivering today, and any technical blockers with backend or design. During Sprint Retrospectives, I focus on continuous improvement: if a feature was delayed due to third-party API changes, we discuss how we can mock dependencies earlier in the sprint next time."

5. Stage 5: High-Impact Reverse Questions to Ask Them

When the interviewer asks: "Do you have any questions for us?", **never say "No, everything was clear."**

Ask 2 or 3 of these high-impact questions to prove your senior mindset:

1. **Architecture & Launch (Targeted to this JD):**

"Given that this internal application is preparing for its production launch, what are the biggest technical risks or stability hurdles the team is focused on resolving right now?"

2. **Web Portal vs Mobile Balance:**

"How is user traffic split between the mobile app and the portal/tablet interface, and are there plans to introduce more desktop-specific workflows?"

3. **Engineering Culture & CI/CD:**

"What does the current automated testing and CI/CD deployment pipeline look like for your staging and production releases?"

4. **Success Metrics:**

"If I join the team, what would success look like for me in the first 90 days ahead of the production rollout?"

6. Pre-Interview Checklist for Friday Morning (10:00 AM)

- ☐ **Hardware & Internet:**
 - Test webcam, microphone, and headphones 30 minutes early.
 - Ensure stable high-speed WiFi (keep a mobile hotspot ready as backup).
- ☐ **Workspace Setup:**
 - Open VS Code or Android Studio with a clean project ready if live coding is requested.
 - Set editor font size to 16px–18px for clear screen-sharing.
 - Put phone on silent mode.

- ☐ **Mindset & Body Language:**
 - Dress professionally (smart casual / collared shirt).
 - Look into the camera when speaking to maintain virtual eye contact.
 - Smile and speak with steady, positive energy.
 - Remember: You built an entire enterprise offline-first platform from scratch in Fusion, and scaled an existing codebase to 1,000+ brands in Golden Hippo. You have already done everything this job requires!